# Honolulu – Tsunami ESF-6 playbook

**Data as of 2026-10-27**

**County:** Honolulu · **Hazard:** Tsunami

**Planning aid. Supports, does not replace, county emergency plans. Not an official shelter list.**

## 1. Summary

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| People at risk<br>**82,204** | Shelter demand (central)<br>**4,110** | Shelter demand low – high<br>**1,644 – 9,042** |
| Limited English (C)<br>**4,579** | Power-dependent (M)<br>**535** | Disability (I)<br>**9,581** |
| Age 65+ (I)<br>**15,711** | People without a vehicle (T)<br>**11,194** | Known 2026 sites usable<br>**6** |
| At risk, extreme tsunami zone (worst case)<br>**177,475** | | |

Shelter-seeking rates: low 2%, central 5%, high 11.0%. CMIST counts are people at risk, from census-tract estimates; one person can appear in more than one count.

## 2. Scope: county total vs. one community

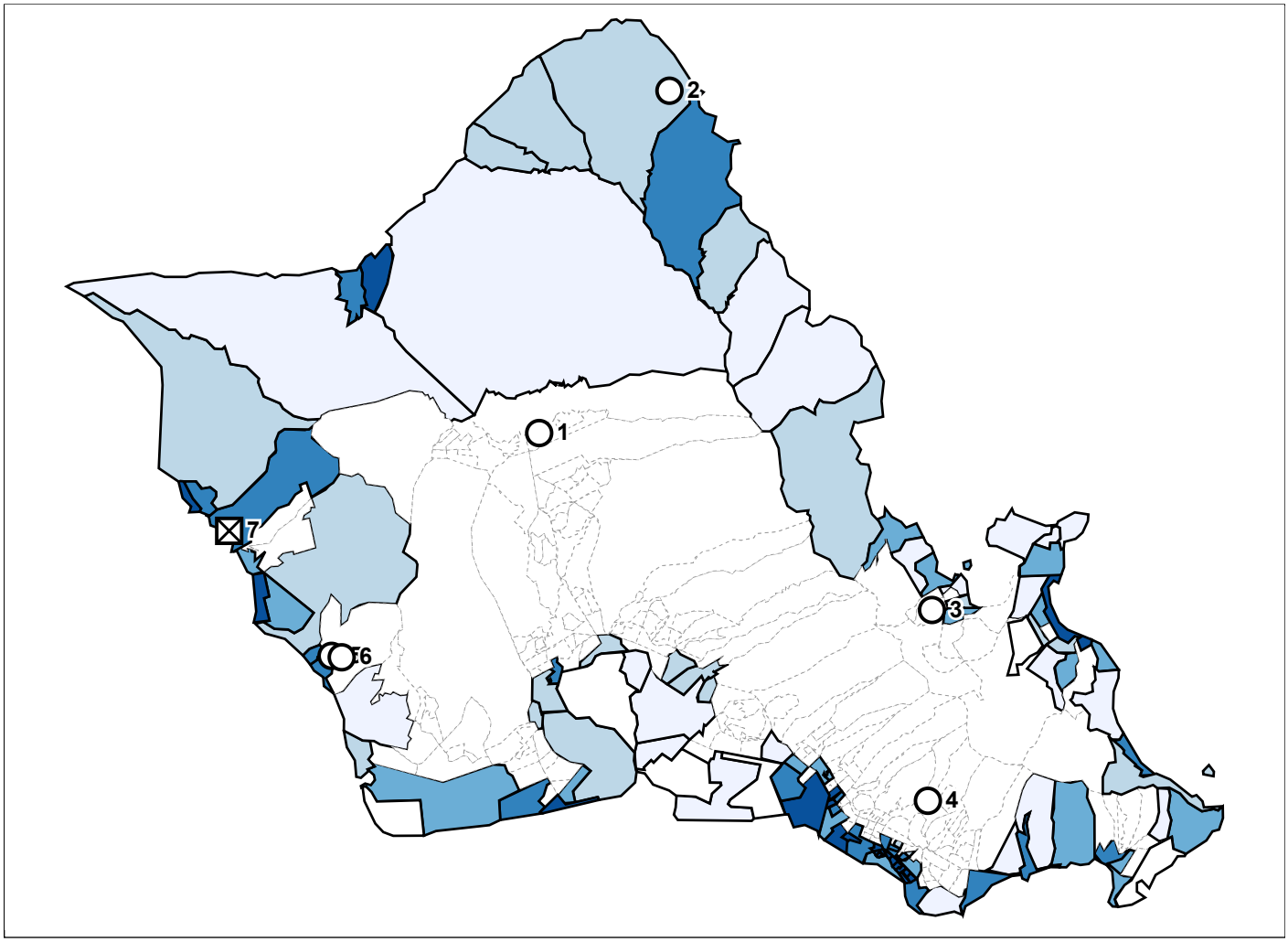
**County total = upper bound.** It assumes every at-risk tract is hit at once (share inside tsunami zone). Real events usually hit fewer communities.

### Largest single community (highest-demand census tracts)

| Tract | At risk | Shelter low / central / high | Limited English | Power-dep. | Disability | 65+ | No vehicle |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Tract 96.10 · Maili | 6,050 | 121 / **302** / 665 | 16 | 32 | 751 | 942 | 101 |
| Tract 84.18 · Ewa Beach | 3,780 | 76 / **189** / 416 | 77 | 22 | 486 | 653 | 56 |
| Tract 112.01 · Kailua | 3,491 | 70 / **175** / 384 | 30 | 30 | 299 | 885 | 65 |

Plan a realistic one-community event with the first row.

### 3. Map: AFN need and known sites




- AFN need 0–22 people (class 1 of 5)
- AFN need 22–70 people (class 2 of 5)
- AFN need 70–153 people (class 3 of 5)
- AFN need 153–392 people (class 4 of 5)
- AFN need 392–1,400 people (class 5 of 5)
- Solid outline: tract in hazard footprint (at risk)
- Dashed outline: not in footprint
- Usable
- Check: flood (SFHA)
- Check: flood (tract-level)
- Flood risk undetermined (zone D)
- Excluded: tsunami zone

AFN need = power-dependent + disability + limited English + no-vehicle people at risk (people may be counted more than once). Numbers on markers match the sites table. No basemap: tract outlines only.

## 4. Known sites (opened in 2026 events)

| # | Status | Site | Address | Reason | Times opened 2026 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | ✓ **Usable** | George Fred Wright Wahiawā District Park | 1139-A Kilani Avenue, Wahiawā 96786 | outside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |
| 2 | ✓ **Usable** | Kahuku Elementary School | | outside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |
| 3 | ✓ **Usable** | Kāneʻohe District Park | 45-660 Keaʻahala Road, Kāneʻohe 96744 | outside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |
| 4 | ✓ **Usable** | Mānoa Valley District Park | 2721 Kaʻaipū Avenue, Honolulu 96822 | outside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |
| 5 | ✓ **Usable** | Nānākuli Elementary School | 89-778 Haleakala Avenue, Waiʻanae | outside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |
| 6 | ✓ **Usable** | Nānākuli High and Intermediate School | | outside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |
| 7 | ✕ **Excluded** | Waiʻanae District Park | 85-601 Farrington Highway, Waiʻanae 96792 | inside tsunami evacuation zone | 1 |

Candidate public schools in this county usable for this hazard: **135**. Sites are places a county has opened before; not every site opens in every event. Always follow current county announcements.

## 5. Needs and proposed partners

Central estimate. Roles are **proposed – to be confirmed with partner**. Pledged capacity stays blank until a partner confirms it.

| Need | Quantity | Unit | Proposed lead | Proposed support | Pledged | Gap |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cots / sleeping space | 4,111 | cots | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Floor space (≤72 h) | 82,204 | sq ft | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Floor space (≤2 weeks) | 164,408 | sq ft | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Water | 4,111 | gal/day | red_cross | dhs; county_em; doe; salvation_army; hawaii_voad; faith_based; business_community | — | confirm with partner |
| Meals | 8,221 | meals/day | red_cross | dhs; county_em; doe; salvation_army; hawaii_voad; faith_based; business_community | — | confirm with partner |
| Toilets (≤72 h) | 103 | toilets | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Toilets (≤2 weeks) | 206 | toilets | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Shelter staff | 271 | staff per shift | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies; hawaii_voad; oha; salvation_army; philanthropy; business_community | — | confirm with partner |
| Power outlets for power-dependent residents | 27 | outlets | doh | county_em; health_care; utilities | — | confirm with partner |
| Accessible transport | 11,194 | people in no-vehicle households at risk | county_em | dhs; hiema; dot; business_community; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Pet space – dog households | 706 | households with a dog | county_em | hawaii_voad | — | confirm with partner |
| Pet space – cat households | 412 | households with a cat | county_em | hawaii_voad | — | confirm with partner |
| Children's area | 775 | children in shelter | county_em | dhs; hiema; doe; hspls; red_cross; faith_based; other_agencies; doh; health_care; philanthropy | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Ilocano | 43 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Tagalog, Filipino | 42 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Chinese | 41 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Japanese | 29 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Korean | 17 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Vietnamese | 11 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Chuukese | 10 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Hawaiian | 3 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |
| Interpreters – Marshallese | 2 | people with limited English in shelter | dhs | county_em; hiema; hspls; doh; oha; faith_based; other_agencies | — | confirm with partner |

## 6. Decision points

Proposed – supports, does not replace, county plans.

| When | Trigger | Action | Owner (proposed) | Support |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **BEFORE** | Annual pre-positioning review (no official product)<br>County (sets the date) | PRE-POSITION: confirm shelters/refuge outside the tsunami evacuation zone (and extreme zone), transport plan for no-vehicle residents inside the zone, pre-approved multilingual evacuation messages. | County Emergency Management (each county) | hiema, dhs, dot |
| **DURING** | Tsunami Warning<br>NOAA Pacific Tsunami Warning Center (PTWC) | Evacuate the zone; open refuge outside the zone; prioritize residents who cannot evacuate on their own. | County Emergency Management (each county) | hiema, dot, red_cross |
| **AFTER** | Warning cancelled or all clear<br>County / NWS / PTWC | Shelter displaced households, feeding, power for medical devices, donations and volunteers. | American Red Cross | hawaii_voad, doh, utilities, salvation_army |

## 7. Priority outreach and languages

**Top 10 census tracts by AFN need (tract-level counts only)**

| # | Tract | At risk | Power-dep. | Disability | Limited English | No vehicle | AFN need |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Tract 37.02 · Urban Honolulu | 3,054 | 25 | 572 | 295 | 508 | 1,400 |
| 2 | Tract 18.03 · Urban Honolulu | 2,157 | 15 | 227 | 108 | 955 | 1,305 |
| 3 | Tract 37.01 · Urban Honolulu | 2,509 | 15 | 306 | 399 | 523 | 1,243 |
| 4 | Tract 19.07 · Urban Honolulu | 2,604 | 22 | 292 | 268 | 585 | 1,166 |
| 5 | Tract 98.03 · Makaha | 2,188 | 10 | 332 | 455 | 333 | 1,129 |
| 6 | Tract 57 · Urban Honolulu | 1,518 | 12 | 299 | 297 | 499 | 1,107 |
| 7 | Tract 19.06 · Urban Honolulu | 2,595 | 20 | 287 | 218 | 539 | 1,065 |
| 8 | Tract 52 · Urban Honolulu | 912 | 9 | 179 | 282 | 431 | 900 |
| 9 | Tract 96.10 · Maili | 6,050 | 32 | 751 | 16 | 101 | 900 |
| 10 | Tract 38.01 · Urban Honolulu | 1,868 | 11 | 260 | 148 | 453 | 872 |

**Languages: people who speak English less than "very well" (Honolulu)**

| Language | People 5+ | 90% MOE |
|---|---|---|
| Ilocano | 21,729 | ±1,818 |
| Tagalog, Filipino | 21,584 | ±1,870 |
| Chinese | 20,695 | ±1,997 |
| Japanese | 14,936 | ±1,459 |
| Korean | 8,555 | ±1,020 |
| Vietnamese | 5,648 | ±1,522 |
| Chuukese | 4,948 | ±1,848 |
| Hawaiian | 1,318 | ±348 |
| Marshallese | 1,021 | ±345 |

Source: ACS PUMS 2019-2023 5-year (validated against DBEDT Data Book 2024, Table 1.44). Pre-approved message templates: none yet; no machine translation without human review.

## 8. Sources and assumptions

### Planning factors

| Factor | Value | Source or team assumption |
|---|---|---|
| Shelter-seeking rate – Hurricane | 0.02 / 0.03 / 0.05 | South Carolina EMD, 2026 Hurricane Response Annex G (planning factors 2%, 3%, 5%) |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Wildfire | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.112 | high = observed Maui 2023: 1,418 people in shelters on Aug 11, 2023 (Maui Now) / Lahaina CDP population 12,702 (2020 Census) = 0.1116, rounded to 3 decimals = 0.112 (so the calibration event falls inside the band). low and central are team_assumption. |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Tsunami | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.11 | team_assumption: central 5%; low 2% = hurricane planning factor (SCEMD); high 11% = observed Maui 2023 no-notice total-loss rate |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Inland flooding | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.11 | team_assumption: central 5%; low 2% = hurricane planning factor (SCEMD); high 11% = observed Maui 2023 no-notice total-loss rate |
| Shelter-seeking rate – Coastal flooding | 0.02 / 0.05 / 0.11 | team_assumption: central 5%; low 2% = hurricane planning factor (SCEMD); high 11% = observed Maui 2023 no-notice total-loss rate |
| Footprint – Hurricane | all | Hurricanes affect whole islands (Lala, Lowell 2026). |
| Footprint – Tsunami | tsunami_zone_share | Population share inside the State standard tsunami evacuation zone. Extreme zone is reported separately. |
| Footprint – Wildfire | nri_top_share_by_county (25%) | Counties lead mass care, so each county plans for its own highest-risk tracts (team_assumption). |
| Footprint – Inland flooding | nri_top_share_by_county (25%) | Counties lead mass care, so each county plans for its own highest-risk tracts (team_assumption). |
| Footprint – Coastal flooding | nri_top_share_by_county (25%) | Counties lead mass care, so each county plans for its own highest-risk tracts (team_assumption). |
| floor sqft 72h | 20 | Florida DEM Sheltering Guidance Aid (2010): emergency evacuation shelter, <=72 h |
| floor sqft 2wk | 40 | Florida DEM (2010): short-term shelter, <=2 weeks |
| water gal per day | 1 | Florida DEM (2010) |
| meals per day | 2 | Florida DEM (2010): two hot meals a day plus snacks |
| persons per toilet short term | 20 | Florida DEM (2010): short-term shelter, <=2 weeks |
| power outlets per power dependent person | 1 | team_assumption |
| persons per toilet 72h | 40 | Florida DEM (2010): emergency evacuation shelter, <=72 h |
| Staffing ratios | client registration 1:165, dormitory management 1:100, meal service 1:110, mental health 1:250, public health medical 1:200, security 1:100, sanitation 1:200, children area 1:12 | One staff member per N shelter residents, minimum 1 when the shelter is open. Florida DEM (2010) staffing metrics; the source marks them as recommendations. |
| dog owning household share | 0.446 | AVMA U.S. pet ownership statistics (2020 data). Verified in 2022 AVMA Pet Ownership and Demographics Sourcebook, p. 3: 'Dog ownership increased by 6% from 38.4% (2016) to 44.6% (2020)'. The first url did not resolve when checked 2026-10-27. |
| cat owning household share | 0.26 | AVMA (2020 data). Verified in 2022 AVMA Pet Ownership and Demographics Sourcebook, p. 3: 'Cat ownership increased slightly from 25% in 2016 to 26% in 2020'. |

### Data sources

| Source | Fetched | URL / file |
|---|---|---|
| CDC/ATSDR Social Vulnerability Index 2022, census tracts | 2026-10-27 | https://onemap.cdc.gov/onemapservices/rest/services/SVI/CDC_ATSDR_Social_Vulnerability_Index_2022_USA/FeatureServer/2 |

| Source | Fetched | URL / file |
|---|---|---|
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Hurricane | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Hurricane_Hazard_Type_Risk_Index_ |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Wildfire | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Wildfire_Hazard_Type_Risk_Index_Ra |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Tsunami | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Tsunami_Hazard_Type_Risk_Index_R |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Inland Flooding | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Inland_Flooding_Hazard_Type_Risk_I |
| FEMA National Risk Index v1.20, census tracts – Coastal Flooding | 2026-10-27 | https://services.arcgis.com/XG15cJAlne2vxtgt/arcgis/rest/services/National_Risk_Index_Census_Tract_Coastal_Flooding_Hazard_Type_Risk_ |
| Tsunami Evacuation Zones (Statewide GIS) | 2026-10-27 | https://geodata.hawaii.gov/arcgis/rest/services/Hazards/MapServer/2 |
| Extreme Tsunami Evacuation Zones (Statewide GIS) | 2026-10-27 | https://geodata.hawaii.gov/arcgis/rest/services/Hazards/MapServer/12 |
| HHS emPOWER – electricity-dependent DME, county level | 2026-10-27 | https://services2.arcgis.com/ZQ4jTQn6k7VPXEwO/arcgis/rest/services/HHS_emPOWER_REST_Service_Public/FeatureServer/2 |
| Hawaii Statewide GIS – State DFIRM (FEMA flood hazard areas, 6/15/26) | 2026-10-27 | https://geodata.hawaii.gov/arcgis/rest/services/Hazards/MapServer/6 |

| Source | Fetched | URL / file |
|---|---|---|
| County shelter activations 2026 (official county releases) | see table | data/sources/county_shelter_activations.csv |
| 2020 Census Block Assignment File, place/CDP (tract community labels) | 2026-10-27 | https://www2.census.gov/geo/docs/maps-data/data/baf2020/BlockAssign_ST15_HI.zip |
| 2020 Census PL 94-171 block population P1_001N (tract community labels) | 2026-10-27 | https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/decennial/2020/data/01-Redistricting_File--PL_94-171/Hawaii/hi2020.pl.zip |
| ACS PUMS 2019-2023 5-year (detailed languages) | 2026-10-27 | https://www2.census.gov/programs-surveys/acs/data/pums/2023/5-Year/csv_phi.zip |
| DBEDT State of Hawaii Data Book 2024, Table 1.44 (validation) | 2026-10-27 | https://files.hawaii.gov/dbedt/economic/databook/2024-individual/01/014424.pdf |
| Partner list: Hawaii DHS, HAIC 2026 ESF-6 challenge statement | 2026-10-15 | HAIC_AI Challenge_Submission_DHS_Disaster_2026.pdf |
| pre season hurricane | | https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/cphcmission.php |
| hurricane watch | | https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/aboutgloss.shtml |
| hurricane warning | | https://www.nhc.noaa.gov/aboutgloss.shtml |
| tsunami warning | | https://www.tsunami.gov/?page=message_definitions |
| flash flood warning | | https://www.weather.gov/safety/flood-watch-warning |
| red flag warning | | https://www.weather.gov/safety/wildfire-ww |
| coastal flood warning | | https://www.weather.gov/okx/marinedef |

Privacy: aggregate census-tract and county data only. No individual records. Public facility names and addresses only.